



Moving Forward With Trust

Designing Human Accountability Into a Gen AI Workflow

Leadership Forum Community Summit 2026

Ken Judy · Senior Partner, Stride Consulting
kenjudy.us · stride.build



Artificial Intelligence ›

Effect on the Economy

A.I. and Campaigns

Transition for Workers

Anthropic's A.I. Model

China Closing the A.I. Gap

Xbox Hits Reset Button, Laying Off Thousands and Dropping Game Studios

The layoffs were part of wider cuts at Microsoft, as the company prioritizes spending on artificial intelligence.

The initial Xbox layoffs are part of **4,800 job cuts** that Microsoft announced on Monday, a total that accounts for roughly **2 percent of the company's work force**. It is Microsoft's latest employee culling as it plows tens of billions of dollars into the infrastructure for building artificial intelligence.

Software development is a design process



Manufacturing automates the repeated execution of a known solution. **D**esign is the activity of discovering the right solution under uncertainty.

When AI is applied to an undisciplined design process, it speeds up output without improving judgment. You get more of the wrong things faster.

(thank you Mary Poppendieck - author of Lean Software Development)

**Act on anything that
went wrong to avoid
errors of the same
nature in future**

Plan

**Plan what you are
doing**

Act

Do

Check

**Do what you said
you'd do**

**Check that you did it
right**

PDCA Cycle Applied to a Human In The Loop Agentic Workflow

Plan

Analyze the problem broadly tied to a positive user focused outcome

Task out the execution using templated guardrails

Agent is instructed to raise questions of clarification and present artifacts for approval.

Do

Execute in small atomic steps. Rely on programmatic deterministic steps where possible. Rely on Gen AI where fuzzy logic is helpful.

Enforce a feedback loop where the agent is showing its progress at each meaningful step.

Check

Completion analysis:
agent reviews session transcript and generated code against original plan. Verifies against an explicit definition of done.

Agent is instructed to report back with validation points not just a conclusion.

Act

Micro-retrospective.
Agent analyzes what worked and identifies targeted refinements to prompts and interaction patterns for the next cycle.

Agent is instructed to ask socratic questions to elicit insight from the human.

Step 1: Plan



What is the task, and what does a completed cycle deliver?

Example: “Preparing my weekly status update for my manager and key stakeholders — delivers a reviewed, sent update covering what shipped, what's at risk, and what I need from others.”

Step 2: Do



What requires human judgment that can't be delegated to AI?

What can AI execute autonomously, with review at defined gates?

What are the irreversible or highest-stakes moments?

What AI behavior should trigger an immediate STOP?

Step 3: Check



Name 3-5 specific, observable signals of success.

What are the most common failure modes to prevent?

Step 4: Act



What process debt accumulates when this is repeated?

What do you want to learn and improve each cycle?



Access to AI workflow builder skill ▾

Share

(maybe from another conversation or a skill you were planning to build)?

use the pdca scaffold to guide me through creating a skill

Thinking about structuring skill development through Plan-Do-Check-Act cycles

Let's start with Layer 1.

Let's understand the task you want to systematize.

1. In one sentence: what is the task, and what does a completed cycle deliver? (For example: "Weekly client status report — delivers a reviewed, sent report with metrics and risks.")
2. How often is one full cycle performed? (daily / weekly / monthly / quarterly / on-demand / event-triggered)

Write a message...



Sonnet 5 Medium ▾



Plan

Think through
the questions

Do

Run the prompt
builder prompt

Check

Evaluate the
prompt by doing
test run(s)

Act

Use the agent to
help you refine
the prompt



Resources:

ken@kenjudy.us | kjudy@stride.build

Human directed ai workflow skill:

<https://github.com/kenjudy/human-directed-ai-workflow-builder>

